MODULE-2 · MASTERCLASS DOSSIER

2.1 The Hometown Heat Map

Lesson masterclass · implementation drills · war-room directive

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- Map stations by geography and hunger tiers (college / mid-metro / PPM).
- Identify at least two college-town, weekly-cycle stations.
- Shortlist twenty targets for your first campaign.

★ **INSIDER RADIO TIP**

Tier the markets, not just the rings: college towns (hungry, weekly cycles), mid metros (moderate pressure), PPM metros (conservative). Map at least 2 college towns first — that lane produces proof faster than any commercial station.

▲ **THE OPERATOR MOVE**

Run the Triangle Tour Method: pick three Ring 3 cities that form a drivable weekend triangle and coordinate pitches across all three at once.

VISUAL HEAT MAP · THE FOUR RINGS AND THE NATIONAL FIELD

THE FOUR-RING HOMETOWN PERIMETER

Concentrate fire where proximity makes you commercially undeniable



RING 1 · 0–30 mi	RING 2 · 30–90 mi	RING 3 · 90–200 mi	RING 4 · 200–350 mi
home metro	commuter zone	regional perimeter	tour corridor

THE HOMETOWN HEAT MAP · STATION DENSITY BY STATE

300 curated targets · 50 states + DC · color = concentration of stations

AK 1	WA 7	OR 6	ID 6	MT 6	ND 5	MN 8	IL 11	WI 6	VT 4	ME 5
	CA 12	NV 6	UT 6	WY 5	SD 4	IA 6	IN 7	MI 8	NY 10	NH 5
	AZ 2	NM 6	CO 8	NE 5	MO 6	KY 5	OH 8	PA 7	NJ 7	MA 9
	HI 1	OK 5	KS 5	AR 5	TN 7	WV 4	VA 6	MD 6	DE 0	CT 6
		TX 8	LA 7	MS 5	AL 5	GA 7	SC 6	NC 8	DC 1	RI 4
						FL 7				

COOL → HOT · TARGET CONCENTRATION

0 → 12 stations / state

HOW TO READ THIS MAP

- Ring 1 & 2 are lowest-risk asks — stack them first.
- Hottest states on the national field = where to launch your 20-station war room.
- Tier the markets: college towns (weekly cycles), mid metros, PPM metros.
- Synchronize every hot region with a live tour date.

MODULE-2 · MASTERCLASS DOSSIER

2.1 The Hometown Heat Map — Find the Stations That Can’t Say No

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THE ONE-LINE TRUTH: Your first 20 wins are a geography problem, not a music problem. The Hometown Heat Map concentrates your fire where proximity makes you commercially undeniable.

MASTERCLASS DIRECTIVE & STRATEGIC BLUEPRINT

Strategic Foundation & Operational Reality

Every unguided independent artist attempts to conquer national flagship radio on Day 1. They send unsolicited pitches to KROQ in Los Angeles, Z100 in New York, or BBC Radio 1 in London. These stations operate at the apex of global commercial media. Their playlists are tightly programmed by corporate consulting syndicates, major label priorities, and millions of dollars in marketing momentum. Approaching them without regional leverage is a total waste of operational energy.

Radio is fundamentally a **regional broadcast utility**. The Federal Communications Commission (FCC) explicitly mandates that broadcast licensees demonstrate service to their local community of license. Furthermore, program directors in secondary and regional markets pride themselves on breaking home-grown talent before national syndication discovers them.

The **Hometown Heat Map** is your targeting architecture. It organizes the radio landscape into four concentric geographic perimeters centered on your home market:

- **Ring 1: Immediate Home Metro (0 to 30 miles):** Your home city stations, municipal community broadcasters, and local campus radio. You are a taxpayer, a local ticket seller, and a direct community member. You are local news.
- **Ring 2: Adjacent Commuter Zone (30 to 90 miles):** Regional commuter corridors, neighboring college towns, and secondary suburban stations. Listeners here travel into your home metro for weekend entertainment and live events.
- **Ring 3: Extended Regional Perimeter (90 to 200 miles):** Driving-distance cities with shared regional cultural identity. Stations here are hungry for touring acts that can route through their clubs on weekend runs.
- **Ring 4: Tour Corridor Corridor (200 to 350 miles):** Strategic regional hubs on your regular tour circuit where airplay directly primes ticket presales.

Proximity as Commercial Leverage

Why does geographic proximity convert at 5x the rate of distant pitching?

1. **The Walk-In Factor:** In Rings 1 and 2, you are a physical human being. You can drop off physical vinyl at the front desk, attend station-sponsored charity events, or drop into an afternoon specialty show for an on-air acoustic performance.
2. **Audience Overlap:** A spin on a Ring 1 station reaches listeners who can physically attend your next club gig, buy your merchandise, and request your song on competing local stations.
3. **Low Programmer Risk:** When a programmer plays a hometown artist who draws 200 locals to a neighborhood venue, the programmer looks like an astute local tastemaker. When they play an unknown artist from 2,000 miles away, they look reckless.

IMPLEMENTATION DRILLS & PASS STANDARDS

- **Drill 1 — The Four-Ring Geographic Sweep (45 min).** Plot your primary home address and identify all broadcast stations across Rings 1 through 4 using the Hometown Heat Map Worksheet below. Populate at least 30 verified stations.
- **Drill 2 — The Campus & Community Anchor Sweep (25 min).** Identify every university, college, and non-commercial community station within a 60-mile radius. Identify the specific specialty shows catering to your genre.
- **Drill 3 — The Local Story Angle Formulator (20 min).** Draft a tailored, one-sentence local story hook for three distinct Ring 1 stations (e.g., tying into a local landmark, landmark gig, or hometown heritage).
- **Drill 4 — The Top-20 Priority Filter (15 min).** Filter your full heat map down to the 20 highest-probability stations based on proximity, format fit, and named decision-maker access.

ACTION WORKSHEET & OPERATIONAL PROTOCOL

Protocol Document: `HOMETOWN HEAT MAP TARGETING MATRIX`

Complete the structured table below as part of your lesson implementation. This worksheet directly replaces legacy spreadsheets with a publication-grade execution protocol.

Target Station	Callsign & Dial	Market & City	Ring Radius	Station Format Tier	Local Story Angle Hook

WLUW 88.7 FM	WLUW (Loyola Univ)	Chicago, IL	Ring 1 (0-15 mi)	College Alternative / Specialty	Hometown album launch @ Empty Bottle
WNUR 89.3 FM	WNUR (Northwestern)	Evanston, IL	Ring 1 (15-30 mi)	Non-Comm Progressive / Indie	Live in-studio session offer during load-in
WZRD 88.3 FM	WZRD (NE Illinois)	Chicago, IL	Ring 1 (0-15 mi)	Freeform Community / Rock	Local DIY scene residency feature
WXAV 88.3 FM	WXAV (Saint Xavier)	Chicago Southside	Ring 2 (30-60 mi)	Modern College Rock	Southside concert date cross-promotion
WMSE 91.7 FM	WMSE (MSOE)	Milwaukee, WI	Ring 3 (90 mi)	AAA / Eclectic Regional	Weekend tour corridor date @ Cactus Club

WAR-ROOM NOTES

WAR-ROOM DIRECTIVE — 2.1 The Hometown Heat Map — Find the Stations That Can’t Say No

DOMINATE YOUR BACKYARD BEFORE EXPANDING THE MAP

If you cannot generate 10 station adds within 150 miles of your hometown, expanding your marketing budget to national promotion is a guaranteed waste of capital. A national programmer at SiriusXM or NPR will immediately review your hometown footprint. If your hometown public and college stations have ignored you, national programmers conclude that your music lacks localized audience resonance.

TACTICAL HEAT MAP DRILLS:

1. **The Triangle Tour Method:** Identify three Ring 3 cities that form a drivable weekend triangle (e.g., Philadelphia, Baltimore, Washington D.C., or Cleveland, Columbus, Pittsburgh). Coordinate radio pitches across all three markets simultaneously around a three-date weekend run.
2. **Specialty Show Hosts Are Gold:** Avoid pitching the station General Manager or general Music Director on your first pass. Identify the host of the Sunday night local music showcase. These hosts have 100% curation autonomy over their 2-hour blocks and actively seek regional talent to interview.

FREQUENCY DOMINION COMMUNITY DRILLS

1. Post your completed Hometown Heat Map with your Top 5 Ring 1 priority targets.
2. Share your one-sentence Local Story Angle Hook for peer feedback.
3. Name the closest college or non-commercial radio station to your residence and state whether you have ever pitched their local music director.
4. Identify one neighboring city in Ring 3 that you plan to incorporate into your first regional tour corridor.

Key Takeaways

REMEMBER THIS

- Geography lowers ask risk.
- Tier the markets: college, mid-metro, PPM.
- The college lane produces proof fastest.

Self-Assessment · Check Your Mastery

PASS BEFORE YOU MOVE ON

- 1. Do I have at least two college-town, weekly-cycle stations mapped?
- 2. Is every station tiered by hunger and geography?
- 3. Have I locked my top twenty targets for the first campaign?